

Apply to be a Science Corps Fellow - Entry #3364

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Gender
Male
Residence: City (State), Country
Zürich
Nationality
Belgium
When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD?
June 2026
Please tell us briefly about your university education (institution, city, country, year)
The first part of my education was in Belgium at a Catholic secondary school (Institut Saint-Albert de Jodoigne) in the general section, with four hours of math, five hours of French, and five hours of sciences. I also completed my last two years in an immersion program, studying geography and history in Dutch. Followed by general biology with a focus on cellular biology 3 years bachelor (2016-19, University of Namur, Belgium), followed by a master's degree (2 years) in human, cellular, and molecular biology (2020-22, University of Namur, Belgium). During my master program, I spent 10 months on my thesis project at my university in Molecular Virology (2020) followed by 6 months internship At Stanford University (CA, 2021) in molecular neurosciences. Next, I started a Phd (October 2022) in Thomas Lutz Lab (university of Zurich, Vetsuisse) in metabolism (ingestive behavior).
Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow?
I would like to be a Science Corps Fellow because it brings together everything that drives me: scientific exploration, teaching, cultural exchange, and meaningful human connections. As I near the end of my PhD in Neurosciences and Metabolism, I feel more ready than ever to apply my scientific skills, particularly in molecular biology and techniques, in a way that may have a lasting impact beyond the walls of academia. Since childhood, I've been deeply curious, not only about how life works at the molecular level, but also about people, cultures, and places far from my own. The Philippines has always held a special place in my childhood imagination, a dream destination. For years, I've hoped to one day travel in a way that allows me to truly engage with and learn from people. The Science Corps Fellowship offers exactly that: a chance to live and collaborate within a new community while contributing something meaningful.

My background combines neuroscience, metabolism, and strong expertise in molecular biology. Over the course of my PhD and earlier academic journey, I've worked with a wide range of molecular techniques and experimental systems, and I've always been eager to share that knowledge with others. I've mentored numerous students (Bachelor and Master) in the lab, most of whom were taking their first steps into scientific research. I've learned that good teaching is not just about transferring knowledge, but about triggering curiosity, building confidence, and asking ourselves the right questions.

That is what excites me most about this fellowship. I don't see myself simply teaching techniques or delivering lectures. I would love to listen, to adapt to students' needs, and to help build a lasting culture of scientific curiosity. I believe science becomes truly powerful when it's made accessible and collaborative. I value the mission of Science Corps precisely because it aims for long-term impact: empowering local educators and institutions to strengthen STEM education in sustainable ways.

I also see this experience as a profound learning opportunity for myself. Immersing in a new cultural and educational setting will stretch me intellectually and personally, co-creating with humility and openness. My curiosity doesn't stop at the molecular level. It extends to people's stories, ways of learning, and how science can adapt to local contexts.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science Corps Fellow.

I have accumulated a range of experiences that I believe would directly support my success as a Science Corps Fellow.

First and foremost, I have extensive experience mentoring and teaching students at different levels. Throughout my academic journey (from undergraduate to PhD), I have guided many students in laboratory work, theoretical understanding, and project development. Whether explaining complex molecular techniques or helping students interpret experimental data, I've always strived to make science clear, engaging, empowering (and fun!). These experiences have not only honed my communication skills but also deepened my patience, adaptability, and awareness of different learning styles.

In parallel, I've been active in science communication. I have presented my research (5-6 times) through posters and PowerPoint presentations at international conferences, which required me to convey complex scientific concepts to a broad audience, ranging from specialists to non-experts. These opportunities trained me to communicate with clarity and "confidence", and to connect with people from different cultural and academic backgrounds. I believe these public speaking experiences will be particularly valuable when engaging with students and educators in a new setting.

Having worked and studied in multicultural and international environments, I bring strong intercultural sensitivity and a deep respect for diversity. I adapt quickly, listen, and value collaborative diversity. I see the fellowship not as a one-way transfer of knowledge, but as a shared learning experience where I can contribute while growing personally and professionally.

I believe that my experience managing research projects, supervising student work, and balancing multiple responsibilities has given me strong organisational and teamwork skills. I am comfortable taking initiative, solving problems creatively, and working independently while contributing to a collective mission. I am extremely curious and eager to learn and enjoy this project!

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Scientist in academia

Doing science in industry

In science education

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

Within the next 2 years, I envision myself continuing in academia as a postdoctoral researcher, focusing on interdisciplinary projects at the intersection of neuroscience and psychology, particularly in humans. I want to deepen my understanding of brain-behavior relationships and further develop my expertise in cognitive neuroscience at molecular level (Europe or USA).

In the longer term (10 years), I see myself transitioning into the industry or public sector, ideally working on projects with tangible societal impact, such as neurodegenerative diseases and mental health innovation.

Ultimately, I (may want to) become a high school professor, where I can return to the heart of education and inspire the next generation. I want to bring both the depth of my research and to empower younger minds through curiosity and fun.

Please upload your CV (.pdf)

 [CV_Guillaume-Bogaerts.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

An email list in your institution

[Science Corps](#)